

business for himself producing and distributing the plastic. By 1960, he was personally worth well over a million dollars.

John S. Larkins, a young engineer, took over the Elox Corporation—a tiny Royal Oak, Michigan, electronics-equipment manufacturing firm—in 1951. Seeing that there was a great and constantly growing need for electronic-control devices in industry, Larkins concentrated on developing and producing these items. Within six years, he had increased his company's gross sales from \$194,000 to more than \$2,200,000 per year.

In 1942, Charles Bluhdorn, then 16, began his career as a \$15-a-week cotton-brokerage clerk. By 1950, he had made his first million on his own—mostly by importing coffee from Brazil. Today, he is the kingpin of multi-tentacled Gulf & Western Industries, whose annual sales well exceed a billion dollars.

There are innumerable such modern-day success stories.

Among those with which I am personally acquainted, none is more telling or to the point than that of the late Melville (Jack) Forrester.

Jack Forrester served with distinction as an OSS agent in Europe during World War Two. After V-J Day, he found himself in Paris, out of work and low on funds. He finally obtained a job as a sort of bird-dogging contact man with a large investment firm, the World Commerce Corporation.

Forrester toured Europe, the Middle East and Asia, looking

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for promising projects and enterprises in which World Commerce Corporation could invest money. A shrewd and astute businessman, he did so well that within a few years he was made president of the firm's French subsidiary, World Commerce Corporation of France. I had known Jack before the War. I met him again in Paris in 1949. He told me what he had been doing since V-J Day.

"How would you like to do some work for me?" I asked him.